

Word family: **put / putting / put-on**

Base word: put

Past tense: put

Past participle: put

-ing form: putting

Useful family extension: put-on

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / occasionally noun in related expressions

Your sentence:

> “Then, as soon as they **put the headphones on**, everything seemed to fade into the background.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **put ... on** means **to place or position something on your body so that you are wearing or using it**.

Because this construction is essential to your original sentence, it is worth including even though **put on** is normally treated as a phrasal verb.

繁體中文: **把衣物、眼鏡、耳機等放到身上適當位置, 使自己開始穿戴或使用它**

中文翻譯:

> “Then, as soon as they put the headphones on, everything seemed to fade into the background.”

「然後, 他們**一戴上耳機**, 周圍的一切似乎便漸漸淡到背景中。」

put headphones on = 把耳機戴到頭上／耳上, 開始使用耳機

1. **put + object + place/position (物件 + 位置) — 把……放到某個位置**

This is the central physical meaning of **put**.

Meaning: To move or place something in a particular position.

Practice 1

> “Please **put** the keys on the table.”

「請把鑰匙**放在桌上**。」

Practice 2

> “She **put** the documents in her bag.”

「她把文件**放進袋子裡**。」

put something somewhere = 把某物移動並放置到指定位置

2. **put + clothing/accessory/device + on** (衣物／配件／裝置) — 穿上；戴上

This is your original meaning.

Practice 3 — Original

> “As soon as they **put the headphones on**, everything seemed to fade into the background.”

「他們**一戴上耳機**，周圍的一切似乎便淡到背景中。」

Practice 4

> “She **put on** her glasses before reading the document.”

「她看文件前先**戴上眼鏡**。」

Practice 5

> “He **put his jacket on** before going outside.”

「他外出前先**穿上外套**。」

put something on = 把衣物、配件或可穿戴裝置放到身體適當位置，使自己開始穿戴／使用它

Grammar:

> **put on the headphones**

> **put the headphones on**

Both are natural.

With a pronoun:

> **put them on** 

> **put on them** ❌

3. **put + person/thing + in a state/situation (人／事物 + 狀態／處境) — 使.....進入某種狀態或處境**

This is a major figurative extension of the physical idea of “placing.”

Meaning: To cause someone or something to be in a particular condition or situation.

Practice 6

> “The delay **put** us in a difficult position.”

「延誤令我們**陷入困難的處境**。」

Practice 7

> “The good news **put** everyone in a better mood.”

「這個好消息令大家**心情變得更好**。」

put someone/something in + state = 使某人或某事物進入某種狀態或處境

4. **put + person/thing + under pressure/risk/control (壓力／風險／控制) — 使.....承受／受到.....**

Meaning: To cause someone or something to experience a particular pressure, risk, restriction, or influence.

Practice 8

> “The deadline **put** the team under enormous pressure.”

「截止期限令團隊**承受極大壓力**。」

Practice 9

> “The decision could **put** jobs at risk.”

「這項決定可能會**令一些職位面臨風險**。」

put someone/something under/at... = 使某人或某物受到某種壓力、風險或限制

This belongs to the same broad figurative idea as #3, but these patterns are common enough to learn directly.

5. **put + idea/thought/feeling + into words**(想法／感受) — 把.....用語言表達出來

Meaning: To express an idea, thought, or feeling in words.

Practice 10

> “It is difficult to **put** this feeling into words.”

「很難把這種感覺**用說話清楚表達出來**。」

Practice 11

> “She **put** her concerns in writing.”

「她把自己的擔憂**以書面形式表達出來**。」

put something into words/writing = 把想法或感受轉化成可以說出或寫出的語言

6. **put it + way/another way/simply**(表達方式) — 把某件事說成.....;換一種方式表達

Meaning: To express or formulate an idea in a particular way.

Practice 12

> “To **put it simply**, the plan costs too much.”

「**簡單來說**, 這個計劃成本太高。」

Practice 13

> “Let me **put it another way**.”

「讓我**換一種方式說明**。」

put it + expression = 以某種方式措辭或表達一件事情

Common patterns:

* **put it simply** = 簡單來說
* **put it differently** = 換句話說
* **put it another way** = 換一種方式表達
* **well put** = 說得很好／表達得很恰當

7. **put + question/request/proposal + to someone (問題／要求／提議 + 某人) — 向某人提出**

****Meaning:**** To present a question, proposal, argument, or request to someone for consideration or response.

Practice 14

> “I **put** the question to the manager.”

「我向經理**提出了這個問題**。」

Practice 15

> “The proposal was **put** to the committee.”

「這項提案被**提交給委員會考慮**。」

****put something to someone = 把問題、建議或提案正式提出給某人考慮或回答****

8. **put + value/price/figure + on something (價值／價格／數字) — 為……估價；把……定為某個數值**

****Meaning:**** To assign or estimate a particular value, price, figure, or amount.

Practice 16

> “It is difficult to **put** a price on good health.”

「健康的價值很難**用金錢估算**。」

Practice 17

> “Experts **put** the cost at around two million dollars.”

「專家**估計成本約為二百萬美元**。」

****put a value/price/figure on/at = 為某事估算或指定某個金額／數值****

9. **put + money/resources/time + into something (資金／資源／時間) — 投入**

Meaning: To devote money, effort, time, or other resources to something.

Practice 18

> “The company **put** millions of dollars into the new project.”

「公司向這個新專案**投入了數百萬美元**。」

Practice 19

> “She **put** a lot of time into preparing the presentation.”

「她為準備簡報**投入了大量時間**。」

put something into something = 把金錢、時間、精力或其他資源投入某件事情

10. **put + effort/work/energy + into something (努力／工作／精力) — 花心力於；投入努力**

This is closely related to #9, but especially common with non-material resources.

Practice 20

> “He **put** a great deal of effort into improving his English.”

「他為提升英語能力**付出了大量努力**。」

Practice 21

> “They **put** a lot of work into the campaign.”

「他們在這次宣傳活動中**投入了大量心力和工作**。」

put effort/work into something = 為某事投入大量精力、時間和努力

11. **put + person + in charge / position / role (職責／職位) — 安排／任命某人擔任某角色**

****Meaning:**** To assign someone to a particular role, position, or responsibility.

Practice 22

> “They ****put**** her in charge of the project.”

「他們****安排她負責這個專案****。」

Practice 23

> “The manager ****put**** him in a customer-facing role.”

「經理****安排他擔任需要直接面對顧客的職位****。」

****put someone in a role/position = 安排或指派某人處於某個職位或負責某項工作****

12. ****put + information/name/details + somewhere (資料／姓名／內容 + 文件／表格) — 寫上；填上；輸入****

****Meaning:**** To enter, write, or record information in a particular place.

Practice 24

> “****Put**** your name at the top of the form.”

「請在表格頂部****填上你的姓名****。」

Practice 25

> “I ****put**** the appointment in my calendar.”

「我把這個預約****記錄在日曆裡****。」

****put information somewhere = 把資料寫入、輸入或記錄在指定位置****

This is the informational equivalent of physically “placing” something somewhere.

13. ****put + something + in order/sequence/category (次序／分類) — 排列；整理；歸類****

****Meaning:**** To arrange things according to a particular order or system.

Practice 26

> “Please **put** these files in alphabetical order.”

「請把這些檔案**按字母順序排列好**。」

Practice 27

> “The books were **put** into different categories.”

「這些書被**分到不同類別中**。」

put something in order/category = 把事物安排到指定次序、位置或分類中

14. **put + blame/responsibility/emphasis + on something/someone** (責任／重點) — 把……歸於；把重點放在……

Meaning: To assign blame, responsibility, importance, or emphasis to someone or something.

Practice 28

> “The report **puts** the blame on poor management.”

「報告把責任**歸咎於管理不善**。」

Practice 29

> “The course **puts** more emphasis on practical skills.”

「這個課程**更重視實用技能**。」

put blame/responsibility/emphasis on = 把責任、重要性或注意力歸到某人／某事上

15. **put + faith/trust/confidence + in someone/something** (信任／信心) — 對……寄予信任／信心

Meaning: To place trust or confidence in a person, system, idea, etc.

Practice 30

> “Customers **put** their trust in the company.”

「顧客**把信任寄託在這家公司身上**。」

Practice 31

> “She **put** her faith in the new treatment.”

「她對這種新療法**寄予信心和希望**。」

put trust/faith in = 相信某人或某事可靠、有效或值得依賴

Again, this develops metaphorically from the core idea of “placing” something.

16. **put + event/show/product + on (活動／表演／製作) — 舉辦; 上演; 安排**

This is another very common **put on** meaning.

Because **put on** is already essential to your original sentence, this contrast is especially useful.

Practice 32

> “The school **put on** a concert for parents.”

「學校為家長**舉辦／上演了一場音樂會**。」

Practice 33

> “The theatre is **putting on** a new play.”

「劇院正在**上演一齣新戲劇**。」

put on + event/show = 安排並舉辦／上演某項活動或表演

Compare:

> **put on headphones**

> = 戴上耳機

> **put on a show**

> = 舉辦／上演一場表演

Same form, very different meaning.

17. **put + weight + on(體重) — 增重; 體重增加**

Another very common **put on** use.

Practice 34

> “I **put on** some weight during the holidays.”

「我假期期間**體重增加了一些**。」

Practice 35

> “He has **put on** five kilos.”

「他的**體重增加了五公斤**。」

put on weight = 體重增加

Again:

* **put on a jacket** → 穿上

* **put on a concert** → 舉辦

* **put on weight** → 增重

This is why **put on** has to be interpreted from context.

18. **put + expression/voice/accent + on(表情／聲音／口音) — 故意裝出; 刻意表現**

Meaning: To deliberately produce or pretend to have a particular expression, voice, accent, emotion, etc.

Practice 36

> “He **put on** a serious expression.”

「他**故意擺出一副嚴肅的表情**。」

Practice 37

> “She **put on** a British accent as a joke.”

「她開玩笑地**故意裝出英國口音**。」

put on an expression/accent = 刻意表現或模仿某種表情、聲音或形象, 而不一定是真實自然的

19. **putting = act/process of placing or arranging something — 放置／安排的動作**

Usually **putting** is simply the *-ing form of put**, not a new lexical meaning.

Practice 38

> “She was **putting** the files back on the shelf.”

「她正在把檔案**放回架上**。」

Practice 39

> “**Putting** too much information on one slide can confuse the audience.”

「在一張投影片上**放入太多資訊**可能令觀眾感到混亂。」

putting = put 這個動作正在進行, 或把該動作當作名詞概念使用

20. **putting = golf(高爾夫球)rolling the ball toward the hole — 推桿**

This is a genuinely different specialized but very common sporting meaning.

Here, **putt** is technically a different verb from **put**, although **putting** looks identical in spelling except for the doubled **t** from **putt**.

Practice 40

> “She practised her **putting** before the tournament.”

「她在比賽前練習高爾夫球的**推桿技術**。」

Practice 41

> “Good **putting** can save several shots.”

「良好的**推桿技術**可以節省幾桿。」

⚠ Important:

* **put → putting** = 放置

* **putt → putting** = 高爾夫球推桿

They are different verbs.

21. **put-on = pretence/deception (假裝／騙局) — 裝出來的東西；騙局**

This is a useful family-extension word.

Put-on is an informal noun or adjective derived from **put on**.

Meaning: Something deliberately pretended or staged to deceive or amuse someone.

Practice 42

> “I thought he was angry, but it was all a **put-on**.”

「我以為他真的生氣了，但原來全部只是**裝出來的／做戲而已**。」

Practice 43

> “Her shocked reaction was obviously a **put-on**.”

「她那個震驚反應明顯只是**故意裝出來的**。」

a put-on = 故意假裝出來、並非真實的表現或騙局

This connects naturally to:

> **put on an accent**

> **put on an expression**

because both involve deliberately presenting something that may not be genuine.

Important distinction: **put vs place**

Both can mean 「放」.

put

Very common and neutral.

> “Put the cup on the table.”

「把杯放在桌上。」

place

More formal or deliberate; often suggests careful positioning.

> “She carefully placed the glass on the table.”

「她小心地把玻璃杯放到桌上。」

So **put** is much more common in everyday conversation.

Important distinction: **put vs leave**

put

emphasizes moving something to a position.

> “I put my phone on the desk.”

「我把手機放到桌上。」

leave

can emphasize that it remains there.

> “I left my phone on the desk.”

「我把手機留在桌上／手機留在桌上了。」

Important distinction: **put on vs wear**

Very important for your original sentence.

put on

= the **action of beginning to wear** something

> “She **put on** her headphones.”

「她**戴上了**耳機。」

wear

= the **state of already having it on**

> “She was **wearing** headphones.”

「她當時**戴著**耳機。」

So:

put on = 動作

wear = 狀態

Important distinction: **put vs set**

They can overlap, but:

put

= broadly place something somewhere

set

often suggests placing something deliberately in a particular position or establishing a setting

> “Put the book on the table.”

「把書放在桌上。」

> “Set the alarm for seven.”

「把鬧鐘設定在七時。」

Important grammar point: **put** is irregular but does not change

This is important:

Form	Word	
-----	-----	
Base	put	
Past	put	
Past participle	put	
-ing	putting	

So:

> “I **put** it there yesterday.” 

not:

> “I **putted** it there.” 

But remember:

putted exists as the past tense of golf verb **putt**:

> “He **putted** well.”

「他推桿表現很好。」

Family-extension note

Following our updated Golden Manual rule, these expressions are worth flagging because **put** develops many important constructions:

* **put something on** = 穿／戴上

* **put on a show** = 舉辦／上演

* **put on weight** = 增重

* **put on an accent** = 裝出某種口音

* **put something into words** = 把想法說出來

* **put effort into something** = 投入努力

* **put pressure on someone** = 向某人施壓

* **put someone in charge** = 指派某人負責
 * **put a value on something** = 為某物估價
 * **put trust in someone** = 信任某人
 * **put it simply** = 簡單來說
 * **put-on** = 假裝／做戲／騙人的表現

I would **not** classify all of these as separate meanings of the bare verb **put**. Many are constructions built from one broad semantic idea:

> **placing something physically or figuratively into a position, state, role, expression, or relationship**

That underlying concept is the key to understanding **put**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
put something somewhere	把某物移動並放置到指定位置
put clothing/headphones on	把衣物、配件或可穿戴裝置放到身體適當位置並開始穿戴
put someone in a state/situation	使某人或某事物進入某種狀態或處境
put someone under pressure / at risk	使某人或某物承受壓力、風險或其他影響
put something into words/writing	把想法或感受轉化成可以說出或寫出的語言
put it simply/another way	以某種特定措辭或方式表達一件事情
put a question/proposal to someone	把問題、建議或提案提出給某人考慮或回答
put a price/value/figure on something	為某事估算或指定某個金額或數值
put money/resources into something	把金錢、時間或其他資源投入某項事情
put effort/work into something	為某事投入大量精力、時間和心力
put someone in charge/a role	安排或指派某人擔任某個角色／責任
put information somewhere	把資料寫入、輸入或記錄在指定位置
put something in order/category	把事物安排到指定次序或分類中
put blame/emphasis on	把責任、重要性或重點歸到某人／某事上
put trust/faith in	對某人或某事寄予信任或信心
put on a show/event	安排並舉辦或上演某項活動
put on weight	體重增加
put on an accent/expression	故意裝出某種聲音、表情或形象
putting — put	「放置／安排」這個動作的 -ing 形式
putting — golf	高爾夫球中把球沿地面擊向洞口的推桿動作
put-on	故意裝出來、並非真實的表現或騙局

For your original sentence

> “Then, as soon as they **put** the headphones on, everything seemed to fade into the background.”

The exact meaning is:

****put the headphones on = 把耳機戴到頭上／耳上, 使自己開始佩戴並使用耳機****

So:

> ****as soon as they put the headphones on****

= ****他們一戴上耳機／一開始使用耳機****